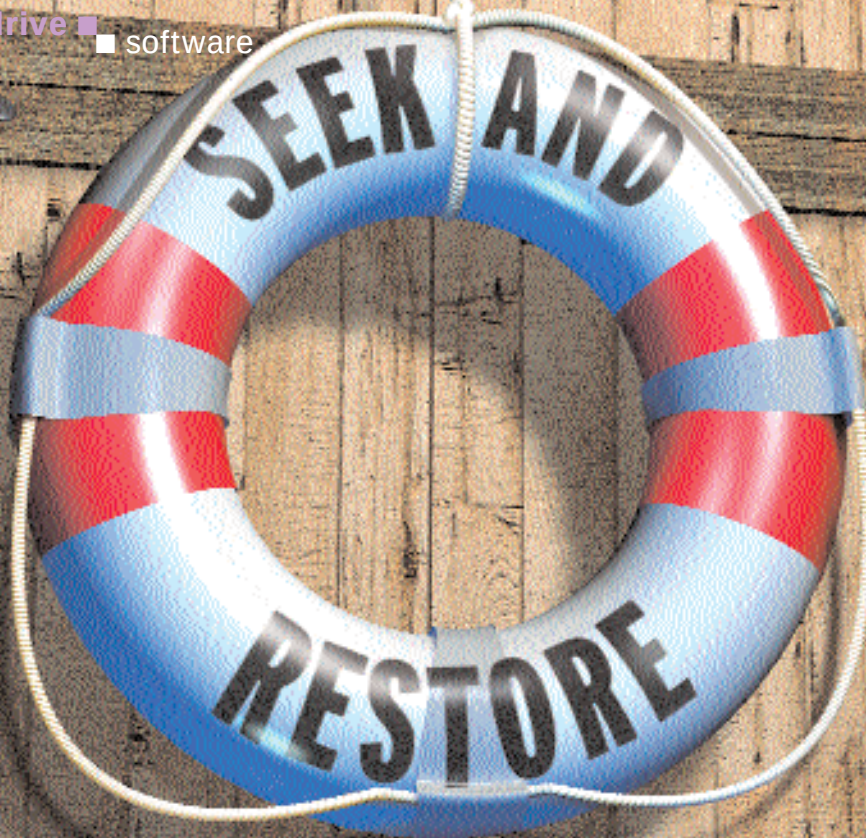




Facing turbulent days of disk crashes, system failures, etc.? Here's a fleet of software that helps you recover and restore precious bytes of records from those technical storms...

Picture this—you're alone in your office at night, at your terminal, typing out furiously for the presentation you're about to deliver the next morning, when, ZAP—the lights go out. You're left fumbling around in your chair in total darkness. When the lights switch back on in a few minutes, you realise to your horror that you hadn't saved your presentation. PowerPoint generally does a poor job of recovering from unsaved files. So you start up EasyRecovery, and with a few mouse clicks, you're back on to your presentation, thanking the universe for watching over you.

EasyRecovery and other similar software do seem miraculous, considering that they can retrieve lost files and deleted documents. All these software serve one basic purpose—they let you bring your PC to its original state with a minimum of trouble. The tools for this fall clearly into

four categories—hard disk imaging tools, rollback utilities, backup software and recovery tools.

Hard disk imaging tools create complete images of your hard disk that can be used later to replicate your data across multiple PCs or hard disks. Rollback utilities, as the name suggests, take periodic snapshots of the entire system, generally called restore points, and then let you 'roll back' the system to any of these previous states. This is possible even if some or all of the important operating system files are missing. The crucial aspect in this case is the time required, and the accuracy, of the restoration. Backup software are programs that let you back up data to a safe place—on another hard disk, or across the network—so that you are not left out in the cold when you lose your data. In recovery tools, the focus is on recovering lost data, without getting into the hassle of backing it up first. These tools

are not a replacement for restoration utilities, but they provide a much simpler approach to recovering lost data.

The plus point for backup-and-restore utilities is that 100 per cent recovery is guaranteed, even with drastic system crashes. The same cannot be said about recovery tools, since they basically scan the hard disk for lost files, and might not be able to recover overwritten data. The advantage, in case of recovery software, is that there are no elaborate procedures to follow—just run the software when some data is lost, and retrieve it. In the case of backup-and-restore utilities, you have to set up restore points and periodically back up your data. This also consumes space.

Find it on the Mindware CD
Restore IT, Second Copy 2000, Ontrack
EasyRecovery Professional 6.03

